

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 1/12: Scope: decline of command, not disappearance

1707 -> imperial command weakens; dynasty, titles and Persianate grammar endure

CORE WINDOW -> succession, factions, jagirs, regions and Nadir Shah to the 1740s

NOT THE CLAIM -> instant 1707 collapse, universal Indian decline or Company inevitability

ANSWER RULE -> distinguish enforceable authority from symbolic legitimacy.

MUST REMEMBER: Aurangzeb's death in 1707 begins the core sequence; succession wars, factional competition, jagirdari-fiscal stress, regional assertion and Nadir Shah's 1739 invasion interacted.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 2/12: Chronology from Aurangzeb to the 1740s

1707 Aurangzeb dies -> Bahadur Shah I 1707-12 -> Jahandar Shah 1712-13

1713 Farrukhsiyar rises with Sayyid support -> 1719 deposition and enthronements

1720 Sayyids fall -> 1724 Nizam's Hyderabad autonomy -> 1739 Karnal and Delhi

1740s -> regional bargaining and frontier pressure; later Durrani/Panipat stay bounded.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 3/12: Succession instability: throne becomes a prize

NO FIXED PRIMOGENITURE -> princes mobilise households and noble clients
SUCCESSION WAR -> victory reallocates mansab, jagir and office
REPEATED CONTEST -> emperor cannot credibly arbitrate elite competition
RESULT -> political transmission fails; it is a mechanism, not a lone cause.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 4/12: Factions and the Sayyid moment

TURANI / IRANI / AFGHAN / HINDUSTANI -> shifting patronage formations
FARRUKHSIYAR 1713 -> Sayyid Brothers supply military-political support
1719 -> kingmaking exposes the throne's dependence on coalition control
1720 -> Sayyids removed; factional politics survives the two individuals.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 5/12: Jagirdari vocabulary prevents category errors

JAGIR -> transferable revenue assignment, not private landownership

JAMA -> assessed claim | HASIL -> realised collection

PAIBAQI -> reserve assignable pool | BE-JAGIRI -> usable jagir shortage

TRAP -> nominal assessment never automatically measures treasury cash or welfare.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 6/12: Fiscal-military feedback loop

MORE CLAIMANTS + WEAK PAIBAQI -> scramble for productive jagirs

SHORT TENURE / EXTRACTION -> resistance, evasion, flight or negotiation

LOWER HASIL -> unpaid contingents and weaker imperial service

WEAKER CONTROL -> regional retention of revenue -> still lower central capacity.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 7/12: Aurangzeb's legacy: a weighted background

DECCAN WAR -> garrisons, transport, remounts and unresolved Maratha challenge

ANNEXATIONS -> territory and claims grow faster than reliable realisation

NORTH ABSENCE -> strains of supervision and arbitration

QUALIFY -> legacy mattered, but Aurangzeb alone cannot explain post-1707 factions or regions.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 8/12: Agrarian and regional assertion

REVENUE PRESSURE -> zamindars, peasants and intermediaries bargain or resist

GOVERNORS + BANKERS + ARMED FOLLOWINGS -> provincial resource control

MARATHA / SIKH / JAT mobilisation -> distinct political routes, not one rebellion

RESULT -> Delhi's weakening and regional state-making reinforce each other.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 9/12: Successor-state spectrum

BENGAL -> Murshid Quli Khan | AWADH -> Saadat Khan | HYDERABAD -> Nizam-ul-Mulk

IMPERIAL OFFICE -> local revenue, army and patronage become durable

COIN / KHUTBA / TITLE -> formal Mughal legitimacy may remain useful

TRAP -> autonomy in substance does not require a modern declaration of independence.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 10/12: Nadir Shah: shock exposes a prior crisis

FRONTIER WEAKNESS + Persian military capacity -> invasion opportunity

KARNAL, 24 FEBRUARY 1739 -> fragmented command loses to unified command

DELHI -> sack, treasury loss and prestige shock; Muhammad Shah remains emperor

VERDICT -> accelerant and revealer, not the original cause of decline.

CLOSE DISTINCTION: Decline of enforceable central command did not mean instant state collapse,
civilisational decline or disappearance of Mughal titles, revenue forms and Persianate
legitimacy.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 11/12: Institutional continuity after contraction

EMPEROR / FARMAN / SANAD -> symbolic arbitration and legal vocabulary

COIN + KHUTBA -> layered legitimacy | PERSIAN CHANCERY -> portable administration

MANSAB / DIWAN / ZAMINDAR -> institutions repurposed in regional arenas

RULE -> continuity of form coexists with change in who commands resources.

EVIDENCE LIMIT: Satish Chandra's jagirdari analysis, regional-state evidence and court chronicles must be compared; no single-ruler or British-inevitability thesis is sufficient.

ASCI MASTER FLOW – PANEL 12/12: Topic 01 answer spine

OPEN -> central fiscal-military command declined inside a continuing political culture

EXPLAIN -> succession + faction + jagir-agrarian strain + regional assertion

WEIGH -> Deccan legacy matters; reject Aurangzeb-only monocausality

TEST -> Nadir 1739 exposes weakness; continuity and regional variation qualify conclusion

CLOSE -> stop core chronology in the 1740s.